



Purnima: Strengthening systems in Local Governments

The devastating earthquake of 2015 cost thousands of lives and damaged infrastructure and livelihood in Nepal. As part of the recovery effort, Mott MacDonald has been managing the UK aid support to the Government of Nepal for building back better and supporting the recovery of livelihoods. The Purnima Programme covers four of the most affected districts of Gorkha, Dhading, Nuwakot and Rasuwa through four components: strengthening local government, direct reconstruction of the rural infrastructure, private sector development, and leave no one behind.

Strengthening systems in Local Governments

Purnima operates in an exciting political context, with a newly established political structure for a federal state providing both opportunities and challenges. The elected leadership in local governments are expected to ensure good governance, establish an efficient system of local self-governance, and accelerate local development based on citizens' participation in the planning process. Purnima works with local government leaders and civil employees and provides technical assistance (TA) to build their capacity, and strategic intervention to ensure effective implementation of reconstruction and recovery efforts that are sustainable and inclusive under the new federal structure.

Purnima works with *gaunpalikas* to strengthen their planning process for both long and short-term goals leading to sustainable development. The planning process provides space to engage leaders, civil servants, stakeholders, and citizens to better define problems, and to identify and build support for effective solutions through meaningful participation.

Strengthening the planning process is at the core of the work that Purnima does with the local government. It addresses critical aspects of the four core areas stipulated in the Local Government Operation Act:

Planning process:

Purnima supports *gaunpalikas* to prepare evidence based, participatory Periodic Plans that are aligned to the Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF). It guides planning through a deliberative and strategic process of preparation and implementation of periodic plans, sectoral plans and annual plans, with detailed budgeting.

Delivery Process:

Purnima supports the delivery process through capacity building support requested by GP. It carries out studies and audits on revenue improvement, GESI, and institutional self-assessments so that gaps are identified and addressed. It also provides evidence based scientific planning and implementation through technological innovations such as GIS, e-procurement, and online surveys. The TA also strives towards transformative change for women and girls.

Implementation and service delivery:

The TA supports *gaunpalikas* to implement and deliver development outcomes through activities delivered by the ward offices and other three outputs of Purnima; Building Infrastructure, Private Sector Development and Leave No One Behind.

Accountability and Transparency Mechanism:

The TA supports *palikas* to practice and maintain accountability and transparency towards their citizens, by providing strategic guidance in the formulation of Acts, policies, guidelines, manuals, citizen charters, bid specifications, and GP codes of conduct. Purnima encourages GPs to record, update, upload, and practice good accountability through proper documentation, and visibility of all its work as a practice of good governance.

Purnima's COVID-19 response and recovery

As a post-disaster programme, Purnima was well placed to pivot quickly to initiate new pandemic relief activities while continuing existing earthquake-recovery ones. Purnima worked with 22 *gaunpalikas* to establish COVID-19 sensitive policies, and programme and operations procedures, focusing on improved service delivery. This has strengthened the capacity of local government, helping them focus on providing immediate relief to the most vulnerable.

Strategic and Deliberative Planning Process

Planning Process Revenue Improvement Action Plan Sectoral Plan

Acts / Guidelines Plans and Policies Budget Periodic Plan



Implementation and Delivery Process

Business Registration E-governance GESI Audit LISA

GESI Perception GIS Alternative Dispute Resolution

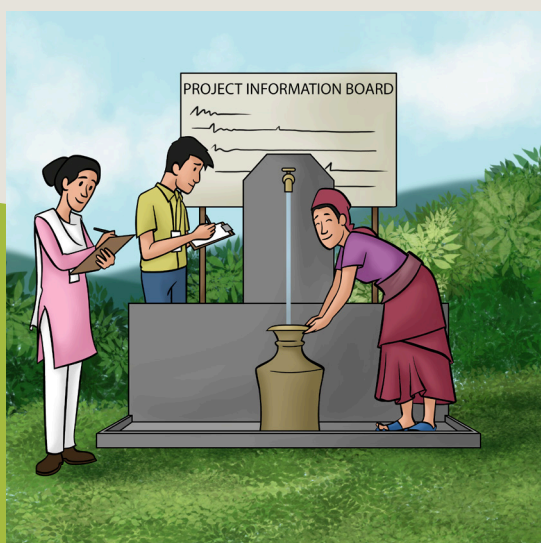


System
Strengthening
of
Palikas

Transparency and Accountability

Citizen Charter Public Hearing Grievance and complaints

Monitoring and Evaluation Public Audits Information Dissemination



Service Delivery

Distribution of disability cards Housing completion certificates

Linkage with private sectors Linkage of vulnerable groups with palikas



Purnima worked with 22 Palikas to establish COVID-19 response plan, policies and programmes and operations procedures focusing on improved service delivery.